

JSS 1 ISLAMIC RELIGIOUS STUDIES

FIRST TERM

TOPIC 1: INTRODUCTION TO THE QUR'AN

1. Meaning of the Qur'an

The word **Qur'an** comes from the Arabic root *qara'a*, which means '**to read**' or '**to recite**'. The Qur'an is the holy book of Islam. It is the final revelation from Allah (God) to mankind, sent through Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

It is also called **Al-Kitab** (The Book), **Al-Furqan** (The Criterion), and **Al-Dhikr** (The Reminder).

2. Importance of the Qur'an

The Qur'an is important for the following reasons:

- It is the word of Allah revealed to guide humanity.
- It is a complete way of life covering belief, worship, morals, and law.
- It is a source of guidance, mercy, and healing for the believers.
- It is protected by Allah from any change or corruption.
- Reading and understanding it brings reward and closeness to Allah.
- It is used in daily prayers (Salah) and is the foundation of Islamic knowledge.

3. Revelation of the Qur'an

The Qur'an was revealed to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) over a period of **23 years** (from 610 CE to 632 CE). The first revelation came in the Cave of Hira when Angel Jibril (Gabriel) brought the first five verses of Surah Al-Alaq.

Revelation came in two main periods:

- **Makkan Period** (13 years): Focused on faith (Tawhid), the Hereafter, and moral teachings.
- **Madinan Period** (10 years): Focused on laws, social rules, and community building.

4. Preservation of the Qur'an

Allah promised to protect the Qur'an. It has been preserved in two main ways:

a) Oral Preservation (Hifz):

Companions memorized the Qur'an as it was revealed. Many Muslims today memorize the entire Qur'an and are called **Hafiz**.

b) Written Preservation:

During the Prophet's lifetime, scribes wrote down the revelations. After his death, Caliph Abu Bakr compiled it into one book. Later, Caliph Uthman standardized the copies and distributed them across the Muslim world. These are known as the **Uthmani Mushafs**.

5. Difference between the Qur'an and Hadith

It is important to distinguish between the Qur'an and Hadith:

Aspect	Qur'an	Hadith
Source	Direct word of Allah	Sayings, actions & approvals of the Prophet
Language	Pure Arabic revelation	Words of the Prophet (in meaning or wording)
Recitation	Recited in Salah; miraculous	Not recited as part of Salah
Protection	Guaranteed by Allah	Preserved through careful scholarship
Authority	Highest authority in Islam	Second source of Islamic law

6. Structure of the Qur'an

- The Qur'an has **114 Surahs** (chapters).
- It has approximately **6,236 Ayahs** (verses).
- It is divided into **30 Juz** (parts) for easy recitation.
- Surahs are classified as Makki or Madani based on the place of revelation.

Summary / Key Points

The Qur'an is the final, complete, and protected revelation from Allah. It guides Muslims in all aspects of life. It was revealed over 23 years, preserved orally and in writing, and is distinct from the Hadith. Every Muslim is encouraged to read, understand, and live by the Qur'an.

End of Topic 1